

Lesson 3: Past Simple (I did) for IT Professionals

Introduction to Past Simple in IT Context

"Hello and welcome to our lesson today. We will focus on the past simple tense, especially 'I did,' and how it is used in the IT field. This tense is very important for talking about things that we have finished or completed in the past. For example, if you finished a project last week, you say, 'I completed the project last week.' This shows that the task is not ongoing anymore, but was done in the past.

In our IT jobs, we often need to report on tasks we have finished or problems we have solved. How do you talk about these past actions? You probably use past simple. For instance, 'I fixed that bug yesterday.' This is a simple way to describe completed activities."

Describing Completed Projects Using Past Simple

"Now, let's talk about how we use past simple to describe projects or tasks we have finished. In IT, we often complete projects or tasks and then need to report on them. We use past simple for this kind of reporting. Like, 'We upgraded the system last month.' It's a completed action, right?"

When you report to a client or a manager, do you use past simple? Like when you say, 'Our team developed the application within six months.' It makes your report clear and shows that the task is already done."

Past Simple in Problem Solving

"Think about the times you solved problems in your IT work. How do you talk about these solved issues? You might say, 'I resolved the network issue last

Friday.' This is about a problem that was solved in the past. Using past simple here is perfect because it clearly states that the problem is no longer present.

In your problem-solving tasks, like fixing bugs or addressing client complaints, you use past simple, don't you? It's very useful for explaining that an issue has been dealt with and is no longer a concern."

Past Simple in Team Updates

"Let's consider how we use past simple in team meetings. When you give updates on what you have achieved, you use past simple. For example, 'I completed the documentation for the project.' It's a straightforward way to talk about tasks you have finished.

In your experience, how does using past simple in team updates help? Does it make your communication about past activities clearer?"

Using Past Simple for Technical Reviews

"In more technical parts of our IT work, how do we use past simple? It's important for doing reviews and audits. When reviewing past activities or system performance, we often use past simple. Like, 'The server experienced downtime last night.' It's a fact about a past event and is best said in a simple way.

Do you notice how using past simple in reviews can give a clear picture of past events and performance?"

Reflecting on Learning and Development

"In IT, reflecting on what we have learned is important. How do you talk about your past learning experiences? You might say, 'I learned Java two years ago.' This shows it's something you did in the past.

Have you thought about how using past simple to talk about your past learning experiences shows your journey and growth in your career?"

Engaging with Your Audience

"What if you did not use past simple to talk about your past work? Think about this. Can you see how it might make your communication less clear? Using past simple correctly is very important for accurate and effective communication in IT.

In your work, how often do you find yourself using past simple? Quite often, I guess? It shows the importance of this simple but powerful tense in our professional lives."

Discussing Project Milestones in Past Simple

"In IT, talking about completed projects is very important. How do you discuss finished projects with your team or clients? We use past simple. For example, 'We completed the system integration last week.' This tells others that the project is no longer in progress. It is finished.

Think about a big project you finished recently. How did you describe it to others? You likely said something like, 'I finished the coding part of the project.' It's clear and direct. We use past simple to show that our work on that part is done."

Reflecting on Problem-Solving Using Past Simple

"Now, consider how you talk about problems you have solved. In IT, solving problems is a big part of our job. When you solve a problem, how do you report it? Maybe, you say, 'I fixed the server issue yesterday.' This shows the problem is not happening anymore.

Can you remember a difficult problem you solved? How did you talk about it after solving it? Probably, you used past simple to make it clear that the issue was resolved."

Past Simple in Updating Project Status

"Let's think about how we use past simple in project status updates. During team meetings, when giving updates about what you have achieved, you use past simple, right? Like, 'I completed my part of the project on time.' It shows clearly that your part is finished.

In your team meetings, when you talk about your completed tasks, do you find it easier to use past simple? It helps to keep your updates clear and concise."

Technical Reviews and Audits in Past Simple

"In the technical reviews and audits we do in IT, past simple is very useful. When you review past activities or system performances, how do you describe them? You might say, 'The system crashed three times last month.' This gives a clear picture of past events.

When you do technical reviews, do you find that using past simple makes it easier to describe what happened in the past?"

Personal Experience in Teaching Past Simple

"I want to share a story from my teaching experience. Once, a student, an IT professional, asked me, 'Why can't we say 'I am fixing the bug yesterday'?' This was a great question. It helped me explain the importance of using the right tense. We use past simple for actions that were completed in the past, not present continuous.

Have you ever been confused about using past simple for past actions? It's a common challenge, but understanding this difference is crucial for clear communication in IT."

Learning and Development Reflections in Past Simple

"In IT, we often look back at what we have learned. How do you talk about your learning experiences in the past? You might use past simple, like 'I learned C++ during my college years.' This shows it's something you did in the past.

When you think about your past learning, do you find it useful to use past simple to describe these experiences?"

Rhetorical Questions for Engagement

"Imagine if you didn't use past simple to talk about your past experiences in IT. How would it affect your conversations? Using past simple correctly is very important for accurate and effective communication about past events.

How often do you use past simple in your day-to-day work? Probably quite a lot, right? It shows how crucial this tense is for us in the IT field."

Past Simple for Clear Historical Context

"In IT, giving a clear historical context is often needed. When discussing past upgrades or system changes, how do you make it clear when it happened? Using past simple, like 'We upgraded our security protocols last year,' helps provide this context.

Do you find that using past simple gives a clearer picture of the timeline of events in your work?"